Brief for the translators of Maqlû (כשפים-ולחשים/מקלו-1/)

▼ Contents

1. Read first (all binding) 1
2. Before drafting 2
3. Drafting, line by line (guidelines §5 step 5) 3
4. The rules most often broken (read again before each incantation) 5
5. The clean translation 5
6. Three review passes (guidelines §5 step 6), each a separate read-through of the whole tablet 6
7. Your section in מקלו-1/project.md 6
8. Limits 7

You translate **one tablet of Maqlû** (or the part of a tablet the coordinator names) into Hebrew, as one of a chain of translators who work **strictly one at a time** (guidelines §5.1: quotas apply in every session). The coordinator gives you the tablet and its key cases in a short prompt; this file holds everything that is the same for every tablet. The user is offline: never ask questions, never wait for confirmation. Decide sensibly, record each decision (with the alternatives) in your section of `project.md`, and finish the work.

Paths below are relative to the corpus folder `שונות/תרגומי-טקסטים-קדומים/כשפים-ולחשים/` (the coordinator gives its absolute path). Use absolute paths in tool calls; keep every command short-running; run Python with `python3 -I -B`.

1. Read first (all binding)

1. `../translation-guidelines.md` – **the whole file** (read it in parts): §1 (the two purposes, and the global aim), §5 (workflow and the lessons of earlier corpora, the ★ rules above all), §6 (principles, echo control), §7 (formats).

2. `corpus.md`, then **`renderings.md` (binding: the names, the witchcraft lexicon, the exorcist and the rite, the materials, fire and burning, the formulas, §7 grammar, §8 reserved words and traps, §9 the fixed lines, §9a, §10)**, then `מקלו-1/project.md` (and the sections of the translators before you).
3. The format model: the first 120 lines of `../ספרות-החכמה-והצדיק-הסובל/3-התפילה-הגדולה-לשמש/annotated-SH.rtl.md` (Akkadian SB, header and apparatus density), and the annotated files of the earlier Maqlû tablets.
4. The base text: `../sources/eBL/Maqlu-<KEY>/reading-edition.md` – per line N (the normalization), T (Abusch's English), notes, and the manuscripts' transliterations (the ATF block: use it for the brackets).

2. Before drafting

- `python3 -I -B maqlu_tools.py pars <KEY>`: every line of your tablet that repeats (identically or nearly) a line elsewhere in Maqlû, or that §9 fixes, **with the Hebrew already given**. That Hebrew binds where the Akkadian is identical; change exactly what the Akkadian changes; note `[מקבילה: <KEY> <line>]` in the apparatus. A deviation from a §9 line needs `[סטייה מן הקבוע: <reason>]` in the entry (the verifier checks it).
- `python3 -I -B maqlu_tools.py lem <KEY> <FROM> [<TO>]`: each word with its lemma candidates from ORACC cmawro (eBL lemmatized only Tablet I). It is a lookup by form, not a parse: **parse every form yourself** (stem, tense, person, ventive, subjunctive, *-ma*).
- `python3 -I -B maqlu_tools.py norm '<Akkadian regex>'`: how a word was rendered so far in Maqlû; `python3 -I -B ../קולות-היום-יום/kol_tools.py lookup '<Akkadian regex>'`: in every earlier corpus; `python3 -I -B maqlu_tools.py grep '<Hebrew regex>' --all`: where a Hebrew string is already used. **Check every new Hebrew word for a recurring lemma against all three before you fix it** (★).
- Read the whole tablet once in the reading edition and decide the section headings: one `##` heading per incantation (a Hebrew title from its content or first words, with the line range), the rubric lines inside it.

3. Drafting, line by line (guidelines §5 step 5)

For **every** eBL label of your range, in eBL's order (including `36a`, `144a`, `A+12`, `78'-79'`, and lines that are
only `…`), write one entry:

```
### 19
`@`
> היא תמות ,ואני אחיה.
- **פירוק:** `šī` — ("היא") נקבה יחיד 3 כינוי; `limūt-ma` — *mâtu* G י"נ 3 רקטיב
- **תרגומים:** eBL (Abusch): "May she die, but I live."
- **הקבלה:** [divergence] `(שמות כב:יז) תְּחַיֶּה לֹא מְכַשֵּׁפָה` — …
- **הערות:** …
```

(An illustration of the format, not binding Hebrew beyond §9.)

- ★ **Write the normalization as `` `@` `` and run `python3 -I -B maqlu_tools.py fill 1-מקלו/annotated-<KEY>.rtl.md`**:
  the tool copies eBL's N exactly. Never retype it.
- ★ `>` is exactly one line of Hebrew, **unvocalized and plene (כתיב מלא) from the first draft**; vocalize only names at
  their first occurrence in the file, ambiguous words, archaic forms, and the always-vocalized words of `renderings.md`
  §8 (the verifier checks them). A vocalized word must strip to the plene string you would otherwise write (`נוֹסַח`,
  not `נָסַח`, if you vocalize it at all).
- **פירוק:** every word: lemma, stem, tense/aspect, person, ventive, subjunctive, *-ma*. **Do not trust a lemma** (eBL's
  or cmawro's): say so when you depart.
- **Brackets** follow the manuscripts: a word is in `[]` when its root, or most of it, is broken in all manuscripts of
  the line (check the ATF block, not only N's brackets). `[…]` for a lost stretch; never fill a gap silently. A line that
  is only `…` gets `> …`.
- **תרגומים:** Abusch's T, quoted briefly, **after** you formed your own reading; record every disagreement and why (★:
  the rank-3 translation is the main source of false echoes; check every negation, stem, precative and "may"
  against the normalization).

- **הקבלה:** the echo check of guidelines §6.4 on every line with a biblical contact: the tag, the verse in the repository's
  format, the biblical words quoted **vocalized, exactly as in `../../../תנך-מנוקד/`**, written `` `...` `` (`ספר פרק:פסוק`).
  ★ Print every verse before quoting it (`python3 -I ../tools/check_bible_quotes.py --show שמות כב יז""`; Psalms
  and Proverbs use a hyphen-minus for maqaf: keep it). The texts to keep in view: Exod 22:17; Deut 18:10–11; Lev
  19:26, 31; 20:6, 27; 1 Sam 28; 2 Kgs 9:22, 30–37; 21:6; Isa 47:9–15; Mic 5:11; Nah 3:4; Mal 3:5; Ezek 13:17–23; Lev 14
  and 16; Num 5; Deut 21:1–9; Ps 7:16–17, 35:7–8, 58, 91:5–6, 109:17–19; Prov 26:27; Job 18:15; Gen 19:24, 28; Isa 34:14;
  19:3. Never force one: most Maqlû lines have none, and that is fine.
- **הערות:** the text **on its own terms** (guidelines §1, §7.2), where an ancient hearer heard more than the words: who
  each god, demon and practitioner is; what the rite does (which figurine, what it is made of, why it is burned, buried,
  given to dogs); the legal frame (the night court, the plaintiff and the defendant, the verdict); the body and its
  parts as the witch's targets; the wordplay (*rittum-ma rittu*, the *-ki* addresses, the paired male/female lists);
  the relation to the Ritual Tablet (which act goes with this incantation). Also cruxes, alternatives, the
  first-occurrence notes `renderings.md` requires.
- **הערת שוליים:** (optional) one sentence for the clean translation, only for the major cruxes and the key biblical
  parallels; it becomes a numbered footnote.

Save as you go (guidelines §5.1): write each incantation's entries to the file as soon as they are drafted (not the
whole tablet at the end), and run `fill` and `verify <KEY>` after each one. A quota stop then loses at most one
incantation. If you are stopped, the coordinator resumes you or a successor from what is on disk.

4. The rules most often broken (read again before each incantation)

- `renderings.md` §8: the reserved and gated strings, checked by `maqlu_tools.py verify` (`אלוהים`, `שאול`, `אוב`, `עולם`, `דמות`, `ידעוני` never; `תמורה`, `עפר`, `טוב`, שרף, `גפרית`, `טיט`, `צלם`, `אשף`, `לחש`, `קסם`, כשף, the net
  words … only for their source word). If the verifier blocks a word that is right, tell the coordinator; never bend
  the Hebrew to pass and never edit the tool's lists.
- **One Hebrew word per Akkadian lemma** (★): the sorcery nouns (*ipšu*, *epšētu*, *kišpū*, *ruḫû*, *rusû*, *upšāšû*),
  the verbs of binding and releasing, the fire verbs (*qamû* `בער`, *qalû* `קלה`, *šarāpu* `שרף`, *ḫamāṭu* `להט`), the
  practitioners. If you need a new one, grep first.
- The persons and genders of address (`renderings.md` §0): the witch is "you" fem. sg. (`־ךְ`, `־ייִך`), the witches
  "you" masc. pl. (`־כם`) or fem. pl. (`־כן`); keep them as the Akkadian has them.
- Present-future of the speaker's acts = participle with the pronoun (`קולה אני`); perfect = past; precative = jussive
  (`יגזור`, `יבער`); no vav-consecutive.
- The formulas (§6) and the fixed lines (§9) character for character; the refrains inside your tablet identical.
- **Biblical vocabulary only when it is the natural word or the cognate, and then tagged.** Maqlû invites Psalms'
  curses and Deuteronomy's lists: a borrowed phrase that the Akkadian does not justify is a false echo; an avoided
  cognate (`מכשפה`, `כשפים`, `גפרית`, `קיטור`, `אשף`, `צלם`) is a hidden echo. Both are errors.
- Do not add what is not in the Akkadian; additions for sense go in `( )`.

5. The clean translation

Write `מקלו-1/translation--intro-<KEY>.rtl.md`: `# <the tablet's title in Hebrew>` and a short Hebrew introduction
(what happens in this tablet and where it stands in the night-and-morning ceremony; the manuscripts and the edition in a
sentence; for Tablet I, also the signs: `[ ]`, `[…]`, `…`, `( )`, `?`, *italics*, `⟨ ⟩`). Never open a paragraph with bold text (the builder reads `**label**` lines as numbered lines). Then run `python3 -I -B maqlu_tools.py build`: it

generates `translation-<KEY>.rtl.md` and the combined `translation.rtl.md` from your intro and the annotated `##`
headings, `>` lines and `הערת שוליים` bullets, and verifies. Never edit a generated file.

6. Three review passes (guidelines §5 step 6), each a separate read-through of the whole tablet

- **(a) fidelity:** every content word accounted for; nothing added outside `( )`; brackets checked against the ATF.
- **(b) consistency:** formulas, fixed and repeated lines identical (`verify` lists every difference: justify it in the
  apparatus or fix it); names; `renderings.md` respected; every new Hebrew string grepped against the earlier tablets.
- **(c) Hebrew:** read the generated `translation-<KEY>.rtl.md` aloud; register even; no unintended biblical calques.
- Then `python3 -I ../tools/check_bible_quotes.py מקלו-1/annotated-<KEY>.rtl.md מקלו-1/translation--intro-<KEY>.rtl.md מקלו-1/translation-<KEY>.rtl.md` and fix every mismatch; `python3 -I -B maqlu_tools.py verify <KEY> --strict` must
  report **no problems**.

7. Your section in `מקלו-1/project.md`

Insert it **above** the line `## Parallels index` (do not rewrite earlier sections): `## Tablet <KEY>` with, in English
(Bible quotations in Hebrew, vocalized):

- `### Scope` (labels, preservation, manuscripts in a sentence);
- `### Sources consulted`;
- `### Decisions` (renderings you fixed, the rejected alternatives and the reason);
- `### Open decisions for the user`;
- `### Progress log` (drafting, the three passes with what each changed, the verify and quote checks);
- `### The text on its own terms`: 5–15 bullets – what this tablet shows of the ancient mind, each with its lines;
- `### Key parallels`: the 3–10 strongest Bible contacts in a sentence each (the full table is generated from your
  הקבלה bullets by `build_parallels_index.py`: write those bullets carefully, a tag before each contact);
- `### Lines shared with other tablets` (what you copied, what differs and why);
- `### Proposals for the shared renderings` (new recurring words, formulas, names – with Hebrew and reason);
- `### Lessons for the guidelines` (only what generalizes).

8. Limits

- Edit only your annotated file, your `translation--intro-<KEY>.rtl.md`, the generated files (through `build`) and your
  section of `project.md`. Do not edit `renderings.md`, other tablets' files, other corpora, the guidelines, the tools or
  anything in `../sources/` (if a tool has a bug, say so in your final message; a minimal fix is allowed only if it
  blocks you, and must be reported). Do not commit. **Do not start sub-agents.**
- If you cannot finish, finish the entries you start, leave `<!-- טרם תורגם: <first>–<last> -->` where the rest
  belongs, build the clean translation for what is done, and say exactly where you stopped.
- Your final message to the coordinator (short): labels done, the main decisions, the strongest parallels and the
  strongest "ancient mind" findings, open decisions, problems.